

How much better?

Comparativos como better ou more expensive dizem que algo é diferente. Mas o inglês tem um jeito de dizer o tamanho dessa diferença: enorme, pequena, igual ou nenhuma vantagem.

TEXTO ADAPTADO NÍVEL B1+

ganbare - you've got this

01 Kyoto or Osaka?

Leitura - By Yuki Tanaka

People always ask me which city I prefer, Kyoto or Osaka. Honestly, it depends on what you want. Kyoto is **way quieter** than Osaka. The temples, the gardens, the narrow¹ streets all feel calmer. If you want peace, Kyoto wins easily.

Osaka, though, is **a lot more fun** at night. The food scene is **way better**, in my opinion, and the people are **much more relaxed** with strangers. Kyoto can feel **a little more formal** sometimes, almost too polite.

Prices² are **not as different** as people think. Osaka is **only slightly cheaper** for food, and hotels in both cities cost roughly the same. If price is your main worry, the city itself won't change much.

What surprised me most was the trains. Kyoto's local buses are **nowhere near as convenient**³ as Osaka's subway system. In Osaka, everything connects. In Kyoto, you often wait, transfer⁴, and wait again.

In the end, Kyoto is **just as beautiful** as everyone says, but Osaka is **far friendlier** for a short, easy trip. Choose based on what kind of exhausted⁵ you want to feel by the end of the day.

NOTAS DE LEITURA - GLOSSÁRIO

1. **narrow:** not wide (*estreito(a)*; 狭い)
2. **price / budget:** the cost of something, or the money available (*preço, orçamento*; 予算・価格)
3. **convenient:** easy and practical to use (*conveniente, práctico*; 便利な)
4. **to transfer:** to change from one train or bus to another (*fazer baldeação*; 乗り換える)
5. **exhausted:** extremely tired (*exausto(a)*; 疲れ果てた)

DIFERENÇA ENORME

way / far / a lot / much*"This hotel is way more expensive than that one."*

DIFERENÇA PEQUENA

slightly / a bit / a little*"The train is only slightly faster than the bus."*

SEM DIFERENÇA

just as ... as*"This restaurant is just as good as the other one."*

SEM VANTAGEM NENHUMA

not / nowhere near as ... as*"This hotel is nowhere near as comfortable as a ryokan."*

Regra de ouro: "way" e "far" só combinam com comparativos ("way better"), nunca com "as...as". Nunca "way as good as".

CONTEXTO	ESTRUTURA	EXEMPLO
Apartamento de \$3.000 vs. \$1.200	Diferença enorme	Tokyo is way more expensive than Osaka.
Trem de 58min vs. 61min	Diferença pequena	The bullet train is slightly faster than the express.
Dois restaurantes, mesma nota 4.5	Sem diferença	This one is just as good as the other.
Hotel com ar-condicionado quebrado	Sem vantagem nenhuma	It's nowhere near as luxurious as it claims.

02.1 Practice

02.01

Renting an apartment in Tokyo costs about \$3,000 a month. A similar apartment in Osaka costs about \$1,200.

Tokyo is _____ Osaka. (*expensive · diferença enorme*)

02.02

A famous guidebook gives one guesthouse 2 stars and another 4.8 stars, mentioning dirty rooms and rude staff at the first one.

This guesthouse is _____ the other one. (*good · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

02.03

The bullet train takes 58 minutes. The express train takes 61 minutes.

The bullet train is _____ the express train. (*fast · diferença pequena*)

02.04

Both flights depart at the same time, cost exactly \$340, and are non-stop on the same airline.

Flight A is _____ Flight B. (*expensive · sem diferença*)

02.05

The new stadium holds 60,000 people. The old one held 15,000.

The new stadium is _____ the old one. (*big · diferença enorme*)

02.06

Subway Line A carries 500,000 passengers a day. Line B carries 480,000.

Line A is _____ Line B. (*crowded · diferença pequena*)

02.07

A budget hotel review says: "Clean, but the walls are paper thin. Nothing like a real ryokan experience."

This hotel is _____ a traditional ryokan. (*comfortable · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

02.08

Two restaurants both have exactly 4.5 stars on the same review site, same price range, same neighbourhood.

This restaurant is _____ the other one. (*good · sem diferença*)

02.09

One backpack costs \$15. A very similar one, just a different color, costs \$180.

This backpack is _____ that one. (*cheap · diferença enorme*)

02.10

Two coffee shops nearby are rated 4.6 and 4.7 stars.

This cafe is _____ that one. (*popular · diferença pequena*)

02.11

Two guided tours both cost 3,000 yen and both last exactly 2 hours.

This tour is _____ that one. (*long · sem diferença*)

02.12

A "beachfront" hotel turns out to be a 20 minute walk from the beach, with construction noise all night.

This hotel is _____ its brochure promised. (*relaxing · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

03 Mixed Practice

03.01

A coffee here costs \$2.00. The one at the station costs \$2.05.

The coffee here is _____ the one at the station. (*expensive · diferença pequena*)

03.02

Your suitcase weighs 8kg. Your friend's weighs 32kg.

Your friend's suitcase is _____ yours. (*heavy · diferença enorme*)

03.03

Two identical phones, same brand, same model, same specifications, same price.

This phone is _____ that one. (*good · sem diferença*)

03.04

One tour guide has a 4.9 rating and ten years of experience. The other has a 1.5 rating and several complaints.

The second guide is _____ the first one. (*reliable · sem vantagem nenhuma*)

03.05

Two backpacks, both weighed at the airport, both exactly 1.5kg.

This backpack is _____ that one. (*light · sem diferença*)

03.06

One night bus takes 8 hours to arrive. The other takes 14 hours, with three extra stops.

This bus is _____ that one. (*fast · diferença enorme*)

04 Speaking Corner

DISCUSSION

- Compare two cities or neighbourhoods you know well. What's way different between them? What's just about the same?
- Think of two products you've bought that were almost identical in quality but very different in price. Describe the difference using a qualifier.
- Was there ever a time something was advertised as amazing but turned out nowhere near as good as promised? Tell the story.

Answer Key - Gabarito

Practice

- 02.01: way more expensive than (also: far more expensive than)
02.02: nowhere near as good as (also: not as good as)
02.03: slightly faster than (also: a bit faster than)
02.04: just as expensive as
02.05: way bigger than (also: far bigger than)
02.06: slightly more crowded than
02.07: nowhere near as comfortable as
02.08: just as good as
02.09: way cheaper than (also: far cheaper than)
02.10: slightly more popular than (also: a bit more popular than)
02.11: just as long as
02.12: nowhere near as relaxing as (also: not as relaxing as)

Mixed Practice

- 03.01: slightly more expensive than
03.02: way heavier than (also: far heavier than)
03.03: just as good as
03.04: nowhere near as reliable as
03.05: just as light as
03.06: way faster than (also: far faster than)